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Marooned

As we come to the end of this story, many questions pull it like undercurrents. What was the fate of the two steamers? What is the Swadeshi Steam Navigation Company's legacy? How is it remembered? What of the many patriots who gave their all to its successes and failures? Did Indian shipping thrive after the Swadeshi movement?

The Fate of the Steamers

As we saw in an earlier chapter, the steam launch *Miranda* was sold by auction at Tuticorin for a pittance. What we know of the disposal of the *Gallia* and the *Lawoe* is limited. The ownership of the steamers was transferred after the collapse of SSNCo. It is not clear whether the steamers passed into the hands of the debtors for outstanding dues or were sold before the liquidation process began.

As noted earlier, the *Gallia* was sold to J. Mackintosh and Company in 1911, and the port of registry changed to Bombay. The sale may have been in settlement of dues for the purchase and fitting of the boilers. The ship was registered in the name of the new owners and the *Gallia* was tugged away by the *Lady Mackay* from Colombo in May 1911. But on 16 May the tugboat returned to Colombo because of defective machinery, stranding the *Gallia* at Tuticorin. Later it had to be towed by the *Palamcottta*.[1] The *Gallia*'s luck did not seem to have spared even its tugboat.

What was its subsequent fate? Four years later, in 1915, the *Gallia* was sold to the executors of Chubildas Lulloobhoy. Following this, her ownership was transferred in quick succession to Joakin Nahapiet and Company in 1916; Eastern Peninsular Navigation Company in 1919; J.K. Roy in 1920 and, finally, to Sonaton Nittyanundo Roy in 1921—all of them based in Bengal. The *Gallia* sank in the Hooghly on 16 June 1921, a fitting end perhaps to a steamer that had caused much grief to SSNCo.[2]